STOWZA · LAUNCH

Launch Roadmap Play + App Store

Everything between the build that exists today and Stowza live on both stores, in the order it has to happen.

TIME TO LIVE	BLOCKERS	STORE ITEMS	START TODAY
9–12 wks	**5**	**23**	**1 thing**

26 September 2026. Costed and sequenced for: both stores together, publishing as a newly registered company, iOS built on cloud CI, legal pages from a template service. Everything marked "today" was read out of the repository on this date. Money is in the companion cost breakdown.

1. The one thing to start today

REGISTER THE COMPANY, THEN IMMEDIATELY REQUEST A D-U-N-S NUMBER

Everything else on this page is work you control. This is a queue you join, and it is the only item whose duration you cannot compress by working harder.

The chain is strictly sequential: you need a registered legal entity before Dun & Bradstreet will issue a D-U-N-S number, and you need the D-U-N-S number before either Apple or Google will open an organisation account. Company registration takes 1–3 weeks, D-U-N-S up to 2 weeks, and Google says organisation verification can take up to 30 days.

Start it this week and it finishes while you do the engineering. Start it after the engineering and you add six to eight weeks to launch with nothing to show for them.

2. Where the product actually is

Read out of the repository today, not estimated.

AREA	STATE	DETAIL
The app	READY	54 screens, four roles, 1.3.1, TypeScript clean, production build clean. This is not what is holding launch up.
Android SDK levels	READY	`minSdk 24`, `compileSdk 36`, `targetSdk 36` — already meets the API 36 requirement that takes effect 31 August 2026.
Android icons	READY	20 mipmap assets including the adaptive set.
Account deletion	READY	In-app path in Settings. Still needs a matching web page.
iOS project	PARTIAL	Xcode project exists, bundle id `in.stowza.app`, deployment target iOS 15.0, icon set and permission strings present. **But its version is 1.2.0 while Android is 1.3.1** — the iOS target has not been synced since the redesign.
Android signing	BLOCKED	The APKs on the download page are debug builds carrying `android:debuggable="true"`. Gradle is wired for a release key; the key does not exist yet.
Privacy policy	BLOCKED	Exists only as an in-app sheet. Both stores need a public URL.
Backend	PARTIAL	Auth API deployed; six environment variables still unset. Two runtime dependencies are not licensed for production — §5.
Remote push	MISSING	Local notifications only. No FCM, no APNs, no `google-services.json`.
Tests	NONE	Zero test files in the repository.
Crash reporting	NONE	A crash on a stranger's phone is currently invisible to you.

3. The five blockers

#	BLOCKER	OWNER	DURATION	WHY IT BLOCKS
1	**Company + D-U-N-S + account verification**	YOU	6–8 weeks	Sequential chain. Neither store opens an organisation account without it. **The critical path.**
2	**Android release signing key**	YOU	10 minutes	Debug builds are rejected by Play and are a live security weakness as a public download. One `keytool` command; the Gradle side is done.
3	**Public privacy policy + terms**	ME	1 day	Both stores require a crawlable URL. Template service, then I publish to the download site.
4	**Data Safety + App Privacy declarations**	YOU SIGN	1 day	One form per store, both legally binding, both audited against app behaviour. §4.
5	**iOS build pipeline on cloud CI**	ME	2–3 days	No Mac, so releases build on a macOS runner. Certificates, provisioning, signing, upload. Nothing can be submitted to Apple until this exists.

4. The store checklists

23 items. None are hard; any one missing stops that store's submission.

GOOGLE PLAY — 11 items

- [ ] **Android App Bundle (.aab)**, not an APK. Same signing config, one command.
- [ ] **Organisation verification** — company details, address, D-U-N-S, website, phone.
- [ ] **Cap** `READ_EXTERNAL_STORAGE` with `android:maxSdkVersion="32"`. Superseded by `READ_MEDIA_IMAGES` on API 33+.
- [ ] **Location prominent disclosure** — an in-app screen before the permission prompt.
- [ ] **Data Safety form** — §4 below.
- [ ] **Privacy policy URL**, linked from the listing.
- [ ] **Content rating questionnaire** — answer honestly about in-app messaging.
- [ ] **Target audience & ads declaration** — no ads, adult audience.
- [ ] **Account-deletion URL** on the web, matching the in-app path.
- [ ] **Store listing** — icon, feature graphic 1024×500, ≥2 screenshots, descriptions.
- [ ] **Reviewer credentials** — the demo build already solves this.

APPLE APP STORE — 12 items

- [ ] **Organisation enrolment** — legal entity, D-U-N-S, authority to bind the company.
- [ ] **Sync the iOS build to 1.3.1.** It is on 1.2.0 and predates the redesign.
- [ ] **Signing certificates & provisioning profiles**, generated on the CI runner.
- [ ] **App Store Connect record** for bundle id `in.stowza.app`.
- [ ] **TestFlight build** uploaded and tested on a real device.
- [ ] **App Privacy details** — Apple's equivalent of Data Safety.
- [ ] **Encryption / export compliance declaration.** The app uses HTTPS and OTP auth; that is normally the exempt standard-encryption answer, but it must be answered.

- [ ] **Fix the background-location declaration.** `Info.plist` declares `NSLocationAlwaysAndWhenInUseUsageDescription`, which claims background location. The app only uses location during an active trip — see the note below.
- [ ] **Add** `NSPhotoLibraryUsageDescription` if the app reads photos; only the "Add" variant is declared today.
- [ ] **Screenshots per device size** — Apple requires them per supported display class, 1–10 each.
- [ ] **Age rating questionnaire** and full product-page metadata.
- [ ] **Support URL and marketing URL** on the new domain.

THE BACKGROUND-LOCATION MISMATCH IS A LIKELY REJECTION

Declaring `NSLocationAlwaysAndWhenInUse` tells Apple the app tracks location in the background. If the reviewer cannot find a feature that needs it, that is a rejection — and if you declare background location on the Data Safety and App Privacy forms when the app does not do it, the declarations are wrong. Either remove the "Always" string and keep only "WhenInUse", or build a feature that justifies it. **Removing it is the right call.**

The two privacy declarations

Google's Data Safety and Apple's App Privacy ask the same questions in different forms. Stowza touches five categories, and one draws attention:

DATA	WHERE IN THE APP	WHAT TO EXPECT
Email, phone	Sign-in, profile	Routine. Collected, stored, used for identity and the OTP.
Aadhaar / KYC documents	Traveler verification	Government ID — the most sensitive item in the app and the one most likely to draw a review question on both stores. Be ready to explain storage and retention.
Precise location	Trip and parcel tracking	Both forms ask specifically about background collection. Answer "foreground only" — and fix the iOS declaration so that answer is true.
Photos	Hand-over proof	Custody evidence. Retention has to be explained.
Payment info	Wallet, UPI	State exactly what is stored versus handed to a UPI app.

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5. What must be fixed before real users arrive

These do not block submission. They decide whether the first week works.

Two dependencies are not licensed for production

SERVICE	USED FOR	PROBLEM, AND THE FIX
`nominatim.openstreetmap.org`	Address search	OSM's usage policy caps request rates and expects an identifying User-Agent; the app sends only `Accept`. Production traffic gets blocked — and address search is how every booking starts. **Fix:** move to a paid geocoder or self-host.
`router.project-osrm.org`	Fare quotes, drive time	This is OSRM's public **demo** server, documented as demo-only. No SLA. **Fix:** self-host OSRM on a small VPS.

`tiles.openfreemap.org` for the basemap is genuinely free to use and fine at launch scale, though it carries no SLA.

The rest

- **Backend credentials.** Six environment variables: a mail provider, a sending domain, and the OTP store. Without them a new user never receives a code. **Warm the sending domain before launch** — a new domain with no reputation lands in spam, and a user who never gets the code never sees the app.
- **Remote push.** Local notifications cannot tell you a traveler accepted your parcel, because that happens on the server while the app is closed. Needs FCM for Android, APNs for iOS — both free; the work is a Firebase project and a server-side trigger.
- **Crash reporting.** Wire it **before** the first external testers, so their testing produces data.
- **R8.** `minifyEnabled false` on release. Turn it on before testing, not after — R8 breaks reflection-dependent code and you want that failure in front of testers.
- **Tests.** Zero today. The flows worth pinning down are where being wrong costs money or trust: fare calculation, OTP verification, the custody state machine.

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6. The sequence

Ordered by dependency. The verification chain runs in the background while the engineering happens in front of it.



Why 9–12 weeks and not 2. The engineering is roughly three weeks of work. The rest is the verification chain in §1, which runs in parallel but finishes last. If you already had a registered company, this would be a four-week project.

ONE UPSIDE OF PUBLISHING AS A COMPANY

Google's closed-testing requirement — 12 testers opted in for 14 continuous days before production access — applies to personal accounts. Publishing as an organisation replaces that with the verification wait, which runs concurrently with your engineering instead of after it. You still want real testers; you are just not blocked on a 14-day counter.

7. Who does what

ITEM	OWNER	WHY
Register the company; request D-U-N-S	YOU	Legal identity. Needs a CA.
Generate the Android signing key	YOU	It is the app's identity. An agent should not create, hold or transmit it — my sandbox correctly refused when I tried.
Both store accounts, fees, verification	YOU	Legal identity and payment.
Sign the Data Safety and App Privacy forms	YOU	Legal attestations. I prepare every answer from the code; you sign.
Buy the template legal pages	YOU	A purchase. I adapt and publish them.
Retention periods, grievance officer, controller identity	YOU	Facts only you know. Required for an app handling KYC documents.
Release .aab and signed APKs once the key exists	ME	Gradle is wired; one command plus verification.
Sync iOS to 1.3.1; fix the location declaration	ME	Code change.
Cloud CI pipeline for iOS builds	ME	Certificates, provisioning, archive, upload.
Publish privacy, terms and deletion pages	ME	Onto the existing download site.
Permission prune; location disclosure screen	ME	Straightforward code change.
Routing VPS; geocoding migration	ME	Removes the two unlicensed dependencies.
Crash reporting, R8, tests on the money paths	ME	Ordinary engineering.
Store listing assets and copy	ME	The launch film already contains two correctly-sized frames.
Remote push (FCM + APNs)	ME	Needs a Firebase project you create; wiring is mine.

8. What could still move the dates

RISK	IMPACT	WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT
Organisation verification queries	+2–4 wks	The commonest cause is a mismatch between the company address on file and the one given to the store. Use identical details everywhere.
Apple rejects on background location	+1 wk	Avoidable. Fix the `Info.plist` declaration before submitting — §4.
Apple queries the KYC flow	+1–2 wks	Have the retention and storage answer written before you submit, not after they ask.
OTP mail lands in spam	Silent failure	Worst risk on the page because nothing alerts you — users just never arrive. Warm the domain, set SPF and DKIM, test to several providers.
Geocoding gets rate-limited at launch	Booking stops	Migrate off Nominatim before launch, not after the first busy day.
R8 breaks something	+2–3 days	Enable it early so it fails in testing.

RE-CONFIRM THESE AT SUBMISSION, NOT FROM THIS PAGE

Store policies change, and several relevant ones changed within the last year: the Android target-API level, Google's testing requirements, organisation-verification rules, and Apple's encryption declarations. Every requirement in this document was accurate when written. **Read the live requirement in each console the week you submit** — that is the one instruction here that never goes out of date.